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More Ocean Protected, But Is It Enough?

By Daniel · 2026-08-03 · 289 words · L3



해양 보호구역 확대 논쟁

Governments around the world have agreed to protect 30 percent of the ocean by 2030, a goal known as '30x30.' The target was set at a major international biodiversity meeting and is seen as a historic step toward saving marine life.

Marine protected areas, or MPAs, are zones where human activities such as fishing, mining, and drilling are restricted or banned. The idea is to give ocean ecosystems space to recover from decades of overfishing and pollution. Scientists believe well-functioning MPAs can help restore fish populations and protect biodiversity over time.

However, scientists and conservation groups warn that simply drawing lines

on a map is not enough. An MPA only works if it is properly enforced and managed — without that, the designation offers little real protection. Monitoring remote ocean areas is often costly and technically difficult, making consistent enforcement a serious challenge for many countries.

Some MPAs allow certain types of fishing or other commercial activities to continue. Critics argue that these 'paper parks' may count toward the 30 percent target without actually helping marine ecosystems recover.

There are also concerns about fairness. In some coastal communities, fishing is the main source of food and income. When

governments create protected areas without consulting local people, it can cause serious hardship for those who depend on the sea.

Experts point to quality as the key issue. A protected area that is well-monitored, strictly managed, and supported by local communities is far more valuable than a large zone that exists only on paper.

The debate over expanding MPAs shows that international environmental goals are rarely simple. Meeting the 30x30 target by the deadline will require not only political commitment but also real investment in enforcement, community support, and scientific monitoring.

한글 요약

전 세계 각국 정부는 2030년까지 해양의 30%를 보호구역으로 지정하는 '30x30' 목표에 합의했다. 해양보호구역은 어업과 오염으로 훼손된 생태계를 회복시키기 위한 제도이지만, 실질적인 집행과 관리가 없으면 지정만으로는 효과가 없다는 비판이 제기된다. 또한 일부 보호구역은 상업적 활동을 허용하는 '서류상 공원'에 그치거나, 지역 주민과의 협의 없이 설정되어 연안 공동체에 피해를 줄 수 있다는 우려도 존재한다. 전문가들은 목표 달성을 위해 단순한 면적 확대보다 엄격한 관리, 지역사회 지원, 과학적 모니터링에 대한 실질적인 투자가 병행되어야 한다고 강조한다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

marine 바다의, 해양의

biodiversity 생물 다양성

ecosystem 생태계

enforce 시행하다, 집행하다

designation 지정, 명칭 부여

commercial 상업적인

monitoring 감시, 모니터링

commitment 헌신, 약속

The Hidden Workers Who Cross Borders to Care

By Daniel · 2026-08-03 · 284 words · L3



국경을 넘는 돌봄 노동자

Every day, millions of people leave their home countries to care for elderly people, young children, and people with disabilities in wealthier nations. These workers — known as migrant care workers — form a largely invisible part of the global workforce, yet many families in richer countries depend on them deeply.

The Philippines is one of the world's largest senders of care workers. The government runs official training and placement programs, and roughly 10 million Filipinos currently live and work abroad, with a significant share employed as caregivers, nannies, and domestic helpers.

Other major sending countries include Indonesia, Sri Lanka, and nations in

Eastern Europe such as Romania and Ukraine. They typically send workers to destinations like the Gulf states, Japan, South Korea, Taiwan, Singapore, and Western Europe, where aging populations have created strong demand for care services.

Many care workers send money home regularly. These remittances often make up a large share of their families' income and even contribute meaningfully to their home country's economy.

However, the work comes with serious challenges. Care workers frequently lack the legal protections that apply to other employees. Some face long working hours, low wages, and limited freedom of movement. In Gulf

countries, a system called the kafala sponsorship system has been widely criticized for giving employers too much control over workers.

Advocacy groups and labor organizations have pushed for stronger international agreements to protect these workers. Some countries, including the Philippines, require destination countries to meet minimum standards before labor agreements are signed.

The global demand for care work is expected to grow as populations age worldwide. How countries treat the people who do this work will be an increasingly important question in the years ahead.

한글 요약

전 세계 수백만 명의 이주 돌봄 노동자들이 부유한 국가에서 노인·아동·장애인을 돌보고 있으며, 필리핀·인도네시아 등이 주요 송출국으로 일본·한국·서유럽 등지에 노동력을 공급하고 있다. 이들이 본국으로 보내는 송금은 가족과 자국 경제에 중요한 역할을 하지만, 장시간 노동과 낮은 임금, 법적 보호 부재 등 열악한 노동 환경에 놓이는 경우가 많다. 특히 걸프 지역의 카팔라 후원 제도는 고용주에게 과도한 통제권을 부여한다는 점에서 국제적 비판을 받고 있다. 전 세계적인 고령화로 돌봄 노동 수요가 더욱 증가할 것으로 예상되는 가운데, 이주 노동자에 대한 처우 개선과 국제적 보호 기준 마련이 시급한 과제로 떠오르고 있다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

migrant 이주자, 이민자
caregiver 돌봄 제공자, 간병인
remittance 해외 송금
domestic 가정의, 국내의

sponsorship 후원, 보증 제도
advocacy 옹호, 지지 활동
labor agreement 노동 협약

AI's Growing Hunger for Electricity

By Daniel · 2026-08-03 · 300 words · L3



AI 데이터센터의 전력 수요

Artificial intelligence is changing the world — but it is also consuming enormous amounts of electricity. As AI tools become more widely used, the data centers that power them are placing a growing strain on energy grids around the world.

Data centers are large buildings filled with thousands of servers that store and process digital information. Running these servers requires constant electricity, not only for computing but also for cooling systems that prevent the machines from overheating.

In recent years, AI has made data centers far more power-hungry than before. Unlike standard web searches or streaming services, AI tasks such as

training large language models require far greater computing power, which means far greater energy use.

Reports from the energy and technology sectors indicate that data centers have become the fastest-growing source of electricity demand in the world. Data centers already consume hundreds of terawatt-hours of electricity each year, and that figure is expected to rise sharply in the coming years.

AI workloads are said to represent a significant and rising portion of total data-center energy use, and researchers expect that share to keep growing as the technology spreads.

Energy experts say the pace of growth is particularly concerning. Electricity

demand from data centers is rising several times faster than overall global electricity demand, putting pressure on power grids and raising questions about how that energy will be generated.

Many technology companies have responded by setting targets to use more renewable energy. However, critics point out that the speed of AI expansion makes it difficult for clean energy supply to keep up with demand.

For students growing up with AI tools, the energy cost behind every search or generated image is largely invisible. Understanding that cost may shape how societies choose to develop and regulate AI in the years ahead.

한글 요약

인공지능의 확산으로 데이터 센터의 전력 소비가 급증하고 있으며, 데이터 센터는 현재 전 세계에서 전력 수요가 가장 빠르게 늘어나는 부문으로 부상했다. AI 관련 작업은 일반 디지털 서비스에 비해 훨씬 높은 컴퓨팅 성능을 요구하기 때문에, 데이터 센터의 연간 전력 소비량은 수백 테라와트시에 달하며 앞으로도 계속 증가할 것으로 전망된다. 다수의 기술 기업들이 재생에너지 사용 확대를 목표로 내세우고 있지만, AI 성장 속도가 워낙 빨라 청정에너지 공급이 수요를 따라잡기 어렵다는 비판이 제기된다. AI 이용에 수반되는 에너지 비용을 사회가 인식하고 이해하는 것이, 향후 AI 개발 및 규제 방향을 결정하는 데 중요한 역할을 할 것으로 보인다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

strain 부담, 압박

computing 컴퓨팅, 컴퓨터 처리

terawatt-hour 테라와트시 (전력량 단위)

projection 예측, 전망

consumption 소비(량)

renewable 재생 가능한

expansion 확장, 팽창

Aviation Looks to Cleaner Fuels for Its Future

By Daniel · 2026-08-03 · 273 words · L2



항공 산업의 탈탄소 연료 전환

Aviation accounts for roughly 2.5 percent of global CO2 emissions each year. As passenger numbers continue to rise, pressure on the airline industry to cut its carbon footprint is growing fast.

Sustainable aviation fuel, widely known as SAF, has emerged as the leading near-term solution. Unlike conventional jet fuel, SAF is made from waste materials such as used cooking oil, agricultural residue, and even captured carbon dioxide. It can reduce lifecycle carbon emissions by up to 80 percent compared to standard fuel.

Scaling up production, however, remains a serious challenge. SAF

currently makes up less than one percent of all jet fuel used worldwide. Producing it in large quantities is expensive, and the supply of suitable waste feedstocks is limited. Analysts warn that production capacity will need to grow many times over if SAF is to make a meaningful difference before 2050.

Governments are stepping in with policy. The European Union now requires airlines to blend a set percentage of SAF into their fuel supply. That share must rise steadily over the coming decades. The United States has introduced tax incentives to encourage domestic SAF production as well.

The International Air Transport Association has set a target of net-zero carbon emissions for aviation by 2050. Reaching that goal, industry observers note, will depend not only on SAF but also on improvements in aircraft efficiency and the development of hydrogen-powered planes.

One striking detail: some SAF pathways use captured CO2 as a raw material, meaning that carbon already in the atmosphere could one day help power a flight. Whether that vision becomes reality depends on how quickly investment and technology can scale up together.

한글 요약

항공 부문은 전 세계 이산화탄소 배출량의 약 2.5%를 차지하며, 탄소 감축 압박이 커지는 가운데 폐식용유·농업 부산물 등을 원료로 하는 지속가능항공유(SAF)가 핵심 해결책으로 주목받고 있다. SAF는 기존 연료 대비 생애주기 탄소 배출량을 최대 80%까지 줄일 수 있으나, 현재 전 세계 항공유 사용량의 1% 미만에 그치며 생산 비용과 원료 공급 부족이 주요 과제로 지적된다. 유럽연합의 SAF 혼합 의무화와 미국의 세제 혜택 도입 등 각국 정부의 정책적 지원이 이어지고 있으며, 국제항공운송협회(IATA)는 2050년까지 항공 부문 탄소 순배출 제로 달성을 목표로 설정했다. 전문가들은 이 목표를 실현하기 위해서는 SAF 생산 확대와 함께 항공기 연비 향상 및 수소 동력 항공기 개발이 병행되어야 한다고 강조한다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

sustainable 지속 가능한
emissions 배출물, 배기가스
residue 잔여물, 찌꺼기
lifecycle 수명 주기

feedstock 원료, 공급 원료
incentive 장려책, 유인책
carbon footprint 탄소 발자국

Who Should Tax the Tech Giants?

By Daniel · 2026-08-03 · 283 words · L2



디지털세와 다국적 기업 과세

When a teenager in Seoul streams music, watches videos, or shops on a global platform, the company earning that revenue may pay little or no tax in South Korea. This gap has pushed governments worldwide to look for new ways to tax large multinational tech companies.

A digital services tax, or DST, is a charge that countries place on the revenue tech giants earn from local users. France was among the first to introduce one, setting a rate of 3 percent on digital revenues above a certain threshold. Canada, the United Kingdom, and several other nations have followed with similar measures.

The core argument for a DST is straightforward. Companies like Google, Meta, and Amazon generate enormous profits from users in many countries but often report their taxable income in low-tax locations. Supporters say a DST ensures that these companies contribute fairly to the countries where they actually do business.

However, the policy has created serious trade tensions. The United States has repeatedly pushed back, arguing that DSTs unfairly target American companies. In 2025, the U.S. threatened tariffs of up to 100 percent on imports from countries that imposed such taxes, adding

pressure on governments to reconsider.

At a global level, the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, or OECD, has been working on a long-term solution — a global minimum corporate tax — so that all large companies pay at least 15 percent no matter where they are based. Over 130 countries have agreed to the framework, though putting it fully into practice remains a challenge.

The debate over digital taxation raises a deeper question: in a world where business crosses every border, which country has the right to tax the profits?

한글 요약

글로벌 디지털 플랫폼 기업들이 각국 이용자로부터 막대한 수익을 올리면서도 세금은 저세율 국가에서 납부하는 문제가 불거지면서, 프랑스·캐나다·영국 등 여러 나라가 디지털 서비스세(DST)를 도입했다. 미국은 이러한 세금이 자국 기업을 불공정하게 겨냥한다며 최대 100퍼센트의 보복 관세를 위협하는 등 강하게 반발하고 있다. 경제협력개발기구(OECD)는 130개국 이상의 합의를 바탕으로 글로벌 최저 법인세 15퍼센트를 추진하고 있으나, 실질적인 이행은 여전히 난제로 남아 있다. 디지털 과세 논쟁은 국경을 초월한 비즈니스 환경에서 어느 국가가 과세권을 행사해야 하는가라는 근본적인 문제를 제기하고 있다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

revenue 수익, 매출

multinational 다국적의

threshold 기준선, 한계점

tariff 관세

corporate 기업의

framework 틀, 체계

taxable 과세 대상이 되는

Can Carbon Capture Technology Pay for Itself?

By Daniel · 2026-08-03 · 282 words · L2



탄소 포집 기술은 경제성이 있을까

Every year, human activity releases billions of tonnes of carbon dioxide into the atmosphere, pushing global temperatures higher. Scientists and engineers have developed a technology called carbon capture, which removes CO₂ either from industrial exhaust or directly from the air. The central question now is whether the technology makes financial sense.

Carbon capture works in two main ways. In industrial settings, CO₂ is caught at the source — power plants or factories — before it enters the atmosphere. Direct air capture (DAC) goes further, pulling CO₂ straight from open air using large fans and chemical filters. The

captured gas is then stored underground or converted into other products.

The costs, however, remain steep. DAC currently costs between \$400 and \$1,000 per tonne of CO₂ removed. Analysts project that, as the technology scales up and improves, costs could fall to roughly \$125–\$335 per tonne by the 2030s and possibly below \$100 by 2040. Industrial capture at factories is generally cheaper, but still adds significantly to production costs in sectors like cement and steel.

Governments are stepping in to bridge the financial gap. The United States, the European Union,

and several other countries are offering subsidies and tax credits to make carbon capture projects more attractive to investors. South Korea has also been funding research into the technology as part of its broader climate strategy.

Experts widely view carbon capture as one piece of a larger puzzle rather than a stand-alone answer to climate change. Reducing emissions at the source remains the priority, but carbon capture could play a valuable role in removing CO₂ that other methods cannot easily address. Whether costs fall fast enough to make a real difference remains an open question.

한글 요약

탄소 포집 기술은 산업 시설이나 대기 중에서 이산화탄소를 직접 제거하는 방식으로, 기후변화 대응의 유력한 수단 중 하나로 주목받고 있다. 현재 직접 공기 포집 비용은 톤당 최대 1,000달러에 달하지만, 기술이 발전함에 따라 2040년까지 100달러 이하로 낮아질 것으로 전망된다. 미국, 유럽연합, 한국 등 여러 국가가 보조금과 세액공제를 통해 탄소 포집 기술의 상용화를 지원하고 있다. 전문가들은 탄소 포집을 기후변화의 완전한 해결책이 아닌 보완적 수단으로 보며, 비용 절감 속도가 실질적 성과를 좌우할 핵심 변수가 될 것이라고 강조한다.

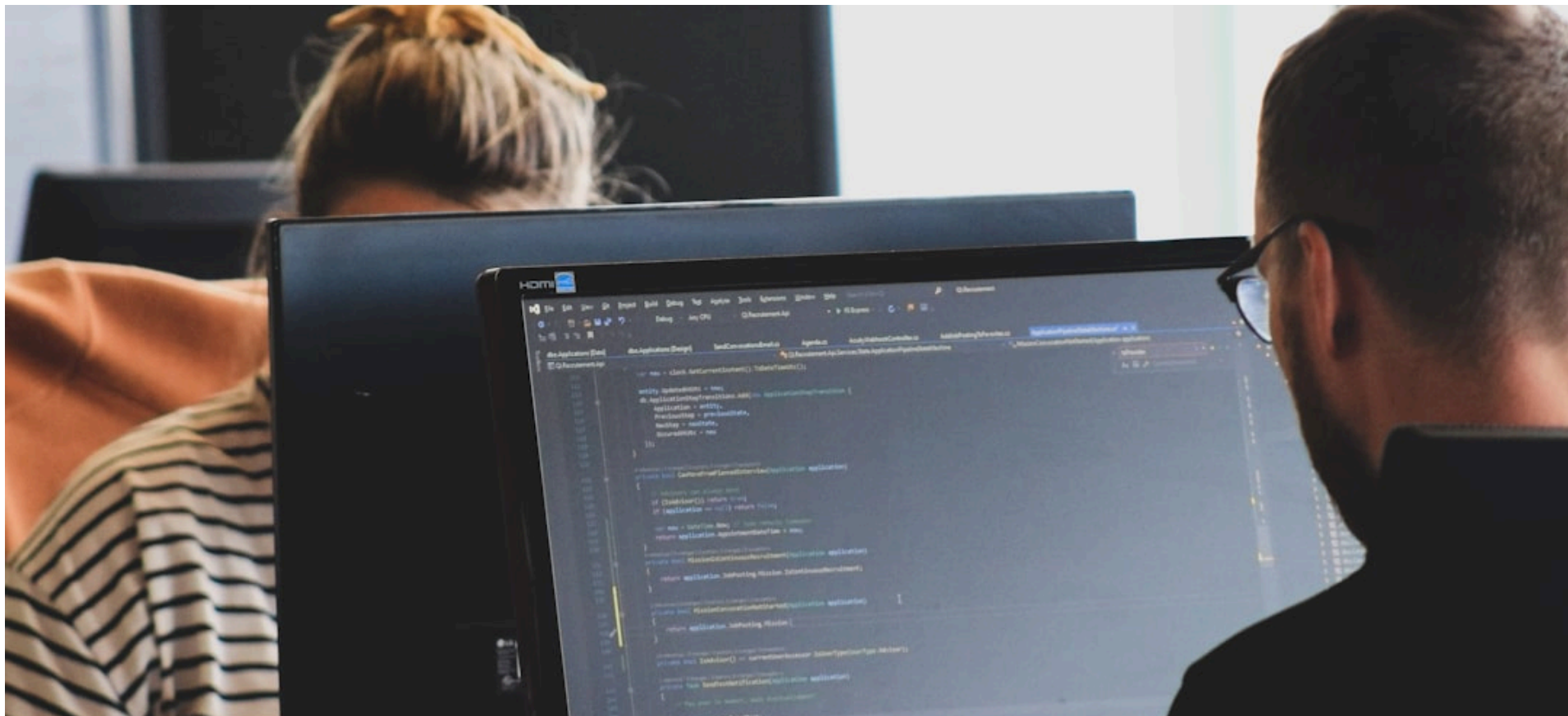
WORDS & MEANINGS

carbon capture 탄소 포집
exhaust 배기가스
filter 필터, 여과 장치
steep (가격이) 매우 높은

subsidy 보조금
sector 부문, 분야
emissions 배출(물)

AI Classes Are Entering Schools Worldwide

By Daniel · 2026-08-03 · 137 words · L1



학교에 들어온 인공지능 수업

Schools in many countries are now teaching students how artificial intelligence works. These classes cover topics such as machine learning, data, and how AI systems make decisions. Students learn through hands-on activities rather than just reading textbooks.

Some countries have begun updating their national curricula to include coding and AI-related content at various grade levels. Governments in several regions now consider AI literacy an important skill for the future, and

more schools are reflecting this in what they teach.

One interesting aspect of these courses is that students do not need to be math experts to begin. Many programs start with simple tools and visual coding platforms that make AI concepts approachable. Many educators believe that learning about AI early helps students become more comfortable with technology and prepares them for careers in a rapidly changing world.

한글 요약

현재 많은 국가의 학교에서 머신러닝, 데이터, AI 의사결정 원리 등을 포함한 인공지능 교육을 도입하고 있다. 여러 국가 정부는 AI 리터러시를 미래 핵심 역량으로 규정하고, 국가 교육과정에 코딩 및 AI 관련 내용을 반영하고 있다. 이러한 교육 프로그램은 수학적 전문 지식 없이도 시각적 코딩 플랫폼 등을 활용해 학생들이 쉽게 접근할 수 있도록 설계되어 있다. 교육자들은 조기 AI 교육이 학생들의 기술 친숙도를 높이고 급변하는 직업 환경에 대한 준비를 돕는다고 강조한다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

artificial intelligence 인공지능

curriculum 교육 과정

literacy 이해 능력, 소양

machine learning 기계 학습

approachable 접근하기 쉬운

platform 플랫폼, 기반 도구

rapidly 빠르게

Youth Unemployment Stays High Around the World

By Daniel · 2026-08-03 · 140 words · L1



청년 실업과 고용 정책

Young people are struggling to find jobs in many countries. The global youth unemployment rate is around 13 percent — more than twice the rate for adults. In some regions, such as parts of Africa and Southern Europe, the number is much higher.

Governments are trying different approaches to fix this problem. Many countries offer job training programs, while others give companies financial support for hiring young workers.

However, experts say that training alone is often not enough if there are too few jobs available.

Some analysts point out that young people today also face a skills gap — the difference between what schools teach and what employers actually need. Closing this gap requires closer cooperation between schools, governments, and businesses. Many economists believe that long-term investment in education and flexible job policies will be key to solving youth unemployment.

한글 요약

전 세계 청년 실업률은 약 13%로 성인 실업률의 두 배를 넘으며, 특히 아프리카와 남유럽 일부 지역에서는 더욱 심각한 수준이다. 각국 정부는 직업 훈련 프로그램 운영과 기업에 대한 재정 지원 등 다양한 대책을 시행하고 있으나, 전문가들은 일자리 자체가 부족한 경우 훈련만으로는 한계가 있다고 경고한다. 또한 학교 교육과 현장에서 요구하는 역량 사이의 기술 격차가 청년 고용을 가로막는 주요 요인으로 지목되고 있다. 경제학자들은 청년 실업 문제의 근본적인 해결을 위해 교육에 대한 장기 투자와 유연한 고용 정책이 필수적이라고 강조한다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

unemployment 실업, 실직

region 지역

approach 접근 방식

financial 재정적인, 금융의

cooperation 협력, 협조

investment 투자

flexible 유연한

Why Electricity Bills Differ Around the World

By Daniel · 2026-08-03 · 138 words · L1



나라별 전기 요금과 에너지 정책

Electricity prices vary widely from country to country. The reasons behind these differences are more complex than most people expect. Government subsidies, energy sources, and national policy all affect what households pay each month.

Some countries produce more renewable energy than they can use. In places like Australia and parts of Europe, this extra supply has sometimes pushed prices so low that consumers are paid to use electricity. These rare "negative pricing"

events occur when solar panels and wind farms generate power faster than the grid can handle.

Other countries depend heavily on imported fossil fuels, making electricity more expensive. Global fuel prices can shift quickly, raising costs for consumers. Governments often respond by subsidizing electricity or setting price caps. How each country balances clean energy goals with affordability shapes the electricity bills that people pay every day.

한글 요약

전기 요금은 국가마다 크게 다르며, 그 차이는 정부 보조금, 에너지 원, 국가 정책 등 복합적인 요인에 의해 결정된다. 재생에너지 공급이 과잉된 일부 국가에서는 전력 수요보다 생산량이 많아질 때 '마이너스 요금'이 발생하기도 한다. 반면 화석연료 수입 의존도가 높은 국가는 글로벌 연료 가격 변동의 영향을 받아 전기 요금이 상승하는 경향이 있다. 각국 정부가 청정에너지 전환 목표와 요금 부담 완화 사이에서 어떤 정책적 균형을 선택하느냐가 가정의 전기 요금을 결정짓는 핵심 변수가 된다.

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WORDS & MEANINGS

subsidy 보조금

renewable 재생 가능한

surplus 잉여, 초과분

grid 전력망

fossil fuel 화석 연료

affordability 가격 적정성, 감당할 수 있는 비용

policy 정책

Satellite Internet Reshapes the Global Space Race

By Daniel · 2026-08-03 · 265 words · L2



위성 인터넷 확장과 우주 경쟁

Thousands of small satellites now orbit Earth at relatively low altitudes, beaming broadband internet to homes, ships, and remote villages that cables could never reach. This shift is changing both how people connect to the internet and how nations compete in space.

For most of its history, satellite internet was slow and expensive. Traditional satellites orbited roughly 35,000 kilometres above Earth, creating noticeable delays in data transmission. The new generation of services works differently, placing hundreds or thousands of satellites in low Earth orbit — between about 500 and 2,000 kilometres up — which cuts those delays sharply.

SpaceX's Starlink leads the field with over 6,000 satellites already in orbit and plans to expand to tens of thousands. The service is now available in more than 100 countries, bringing usable broadband to regions that previously had little or no connectivity.

Other operators are competing hard. OneWeb, backed by the UK government and other investors, has built a constellation of several hundred satellites focused on business and government customers. China's state-backed Guowang project aims to place more than 12,000 satellites in orbit, making it one of the largest planned constellations in the world.

The race has real-world consequences beyond internet access. Low-Earth-orbit constellations are becoming part of national infrastructure strategies, and some governments see them as critical for military communications and disaster response.

Astronomers, however, have raised concerns. Rows of bright satellites crossing the night sky can interfere with telescope observations, and space agencies warn that growing numbers of objects in orbit increase the risk of collisions. Managing orbital traffic is becoming an urgent international challenge.

한글 요약

수천 기의 소형 위성을 저궤도에 배치하는 방식이 확산되면서, 기존 위성 인터넷의 고질적 문제였던 높은 지연과 비용 부담이 크게 해소되고 있다. 스페이스X의 스타링크가 6,000기 이상의 위성으로 100개국 이상에 서비스를 제공하며 업계를 선도하는 가운데, 영국의 원웹과 중국의 귀왕 등도 대규모 위성 군집 구축에 나서며 경쟁이 심화되고 있다. 각국 정부는 저궤도 위성 군집을 군사 통신과 재난 대응을 포함한 국가 핵심 인프라로 인식하기 시작했다. 반면 위성들이 천문 관측을 방해하고 궤도 충돌 위험을 높인다는 우려가 커지면서, 궤도 교통 관리가 시급한 국제적 과제로 부상하고 있다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

constellation 위성군, 별자리
orbit 궤도, 궤도를 돌다
broadband 초고속 인터넷
transmission 전송, 송신

connectivity 연결성
infrastructure 기반 시설
collision 충돌

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